

The One-Page Business Review

Method Guide | Slate Studio

The template is the easy part. **This** is the part that makes a board read it and act. Five minutes — read it once.

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- **one-pager.html** — the builder (open in any browser)
- **One-Page-Business-Review-Method-Guide.pdf** — this guide
- **README.txt** — quick-start

HOW TO USE THE BUILDER

- Open **one-pager.html** in any browser.
- Fill the form on the left — header, 6 KPIs, the story, 3 decisions, outlook. The page on the right updates as you type.
- Set your brand colour (top of the form).
- Click “Print / Save as PDF” → choose “Save as PDF”. You get one clean page. Send that.

THE 6 KPIs — PICK RUTHLESSLY

Six, no more. A board does not read twelve numbers. Use the ones that answer “*are we winning, and is anything on fire*”:

- one **growth** number (revenue / bookings)
- one **vs-plan** number (variance)
- one **profitability** number (margin or EBITDA)
- one **cash** number (cash / runway)
- **two that matter THIS month** (whatever the story is about)

Set the tone: **good** (green), **bad** (orange), **neutral** (grey). Honesty in the colours builds trust faster than good numbers do.

THE STORY — 3 SENTENCES, A FORMULA

Most managers describe; leaders explain. Each line follows:

WHAT happened → **WHY** → **SO WHAT** (is it timing, structural, fixable?)

Example:

“Revenue grew 6% but landed 3% under plan as two deals slipped to Q2 — timing, not lost demand.”

Rules:

- Name the cause, not just the movement.
- Say whether it is one-off or structural. Boards fear surprises, not bad numbers.

- If something is bad, say it in line 1. Hiding it costs you more.

THE 3 DECISIONS — THIS IS THE WHOLE POINT

A report nobody acts on is wallpaper. Every review must end in at most **three decisions**, each with an **owner** and a **date**. Test each one:

- Is it a decision, or just an “FYI”? (Cut FYIs.)
- Does it have a single owner? (No owner = it won't happen.)
- Does it have a date? (No date = it won't happen.)

If you cannot name 3 decisions, the month had no decisions — say so, and the review still took 30 seconds to read. **That is success.**

OUTLOOK — ONE HONEST SENTENCE

Reaffirm or change guidance, and say what has to be true for it. No hedging paragraphs.

PUT IT IN FRONT OF PEOPLE

- Save as PDF and attach it, **or**
- Embed the live builder:

```
<iframe src="one-pager.html" style="width:100%;height:900px;border:0"></iframe>
```

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